Karachi between 8–10 February 1963 was the most critical. Pakistan articulated that they wanted all of Ladakh (a majority Buddhist area) and all of Jammu (a majority Hindu area). The talks broke down at this point.

Pakistan's trade with China over the Shaksgam Valley, which it had wrested from Maharaja Hari Singh through the Gilgit rebellion, was because of the realisation that the Chinese claim to the area, as a traditional trade throughway linking Sinkiang with western Tibet, had more currency because of the numerical superiority of the PLA.[8] The Chinese had shown in Korea that they were willing to sacrifice waves of troops in order to hold on to their perceived strategic positions. Ayub Khan decided that it is better to befriend China and simultaneously use its help against India. The contradictions were obvious. Pakistan, which was a member of SEATO and CENTO, both anti-communist blocs, was cosying up to communist China. Funnily enough, Pakistan had been chosen by the British deep state as the inheritor of British India's northern frontiers just so that it could guard itself against communist penetration. Now Pakistan was ceding vital strategic territory to communist China.

Despite Nehru's public posture of pursuing a rapprochement with the Chinese, the Indian Army continued to send cross-border reconnaissance patrols into Tibet. The second mission was in 1958 and was targeted at collecting evidence about the Chinese highway-building activity in Aksai Chin. Two separate teams were sent across the border: one was an IB team led by Karam Singh and the second was an army team led by Lt. Iyengar. While the IB team returned safely, the army team was captured and interrogated for almost two months.[9] Thereafter, in 1960, the IAF's 106 Squadron called Lynxes conducted several reconnaissance flights over Aksai Chin using Canberra PR 57 aircraft.

These aerial reconnaissance flights were grudgingly authorised by a timid Ministry of Defence after two significant border clashes between the PLA and the Indian Army. The first incident took place in August 1959 at a place called Longju, where there was a firefight between the Indian Army and the PLA. Thereafter, in October 1959, an IB patrol was ambushed by the PLA. Many men were killed and injured and the IB survivors were